Example 1.16 Forensic scientists can determine the height (in cm) of a person based on the length of the thigh bone. They usually do so using the function $h(b) = 2 \cdot 47b + 54 \cdot 10$ where b is the length of the thigh bone.

(i) Verify the function h is one – one or not.

(ii) Also find the height of a person if the length of his thigh bone is 50 cm.

(iii) Find the length of the thigh bone if the height of a person is $147 \cdot 96$ cm.

Solution (i) To check if h is one – one, we assume that $h(b_1) = h(b_2)$.

Then we get, $2 \cdot 47b_1 + 54 \cdot 10 = 2 \cdot 47b_2 + 54 \cdot 10$

$$2 \cdot 47b_1 = 2 \cdot 47b_2$$

$$\Rightarrow b_1 = b_2$$

Thus, $h(b_1) = h(b_2) \Rightarrow b_1 = b_2$. So, the function h is one – one.

(ii) If the length of the thigh bone b = 50, then the height is $h(50) = (2 \cdot 47 \times 50) + 54 \cdot 10 = 177 \cdot 6$ cm.

(iii) If the height of a person is $147 \cdot 96$ cm, then $h(b) = 147 \cdot 96$ and so the length of the thigh bone is given by

$$2 \cdot 47b + 54 \cdot 10 = 147 \cdot 96$$

$$\Rightarrow 2 \cdot 47b = 147 \cdot 96 - 54 \cdot 10 = 93 \cdot 86$$

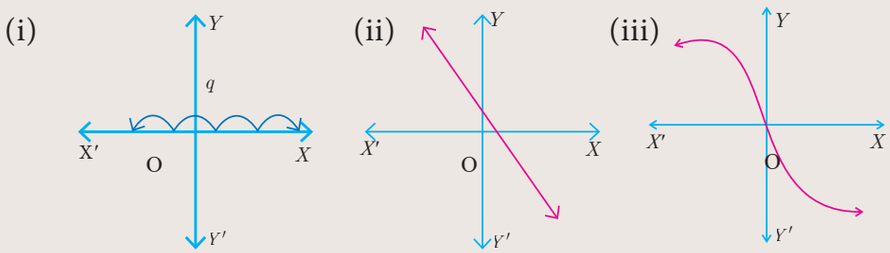
$$b = \frac{93 \cdot 86}{2 \cdot 47} = 38$$

Therefore, the length of the thigh bone is 38 cm.

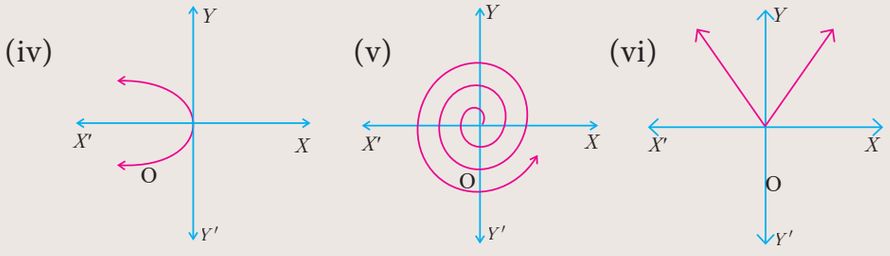
Activity 3

Check whether the following curves represent a function. In the case of a function, check whether it is one-one? (Hint: Use the vertical and the horizontal line tests)

(i) (ii) (iii)



(iv) (v) (vi)



1.8 Special Cases of Functions

There are some special cases of a function which will be very useful. We discuss some of them below

(i) Constant function (ii) Identity function (iii) Real – valued function

1 Relation and Functions.indd 22 15-12-2020 02:50:20 PM